PERFORMANCE OVERVIEW

Where streaming growth comes from

A record-label case study using 2017–2021 Spotify Charts data to identify which markets deserve a closer look and what drives an artist's streaming gains.

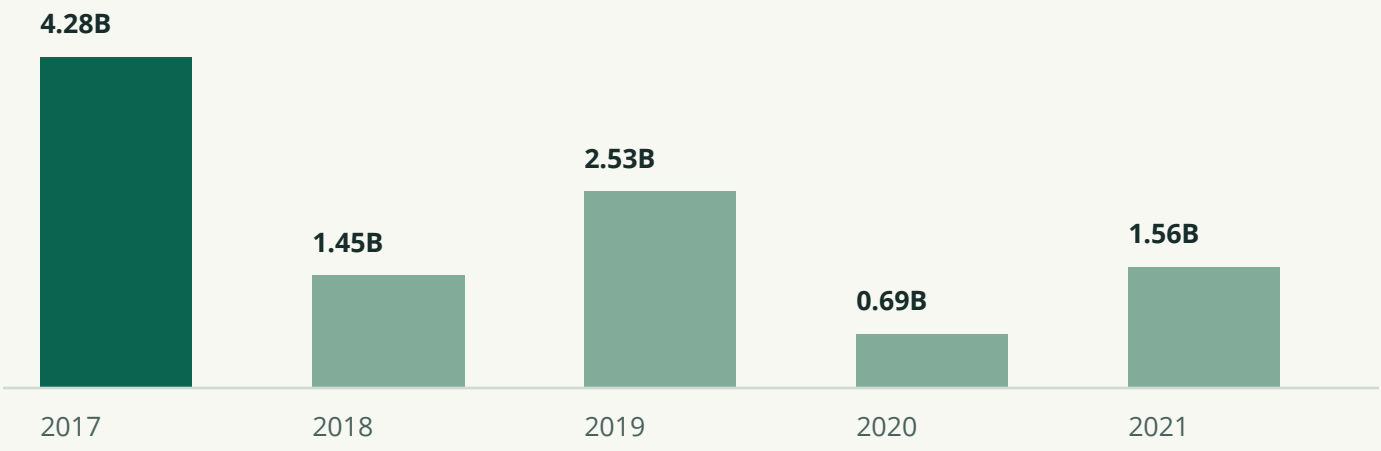
LEADERS BY RECORDED CHART STREAMS

10.52B
Ed Sheeran
Artist credit

2.56B
Blinding Lights
Track · The Weeknd

142.13B
United States
Market

Ed Sheeran's recorded chart streams by year



The rankings sum chart-recorded streams across individual markets. Market coverage changed over the five years, so year-to-year totals reflect both listening and chart coverage.

GEOGRAPHIC OPPORTUNITY

Where artists over-index

Brazil (55.9B) and Mexico (45.6B) ranked second and third by recorded volume across 2017–2021. The 2021 over-index answers a separate question for campaign planning. Where is an artist unusually concentrated relative to the market's share of chart streams?

OVER-INDEX

Share of the artist's streams from a market ÷ that market's share of all included streams. Values above 1.0× show above-average concentration.

2021 examples

Artist credit	Market	Artist streams in market	Over-index
Mata	Poland	131.2M	**56.9×**
sanah	Poland	163.3M	**56.9×**
Ben&Ben	Philippines	183.2M	**40.2×**
Ezhel	Turkey	115.6M	**39.7×**
Zack Tabudlo	Philippines	100.7M	**39.7×**

The screen required at least 100M chart streams per artist credit and 10M in the artist-market pair. Market shares were calculated before applying those thresholds.

LABEL DECISION

Shortlist markets where both concentration and volume are strong. Check current audience and playlist data before committing local campaign spend.

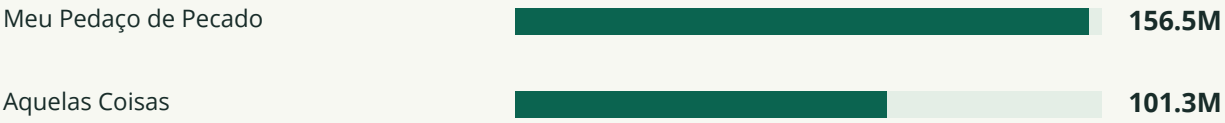
ARTIST MOMENTUM

Two kinds of breakout

João Gomes and Baby Keem both gained more than 100M recorded chart streams from H1 to H2 2021. Their track-level results point to different campaign priorities.

João Gomes

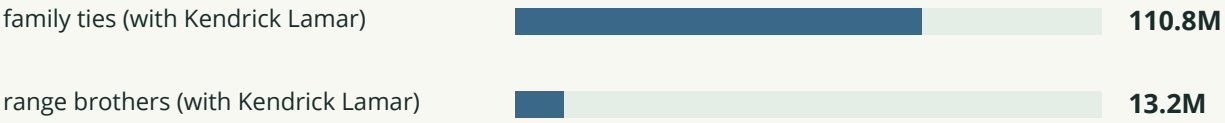
18.1M to 432.2M / +2,293.8%



The two leading tracks accounted for 60% of H2 chart streams. Build a campaign around multiple songs and test which tracks sustain repeat listening.

Baby Keem

7.9M to 136.9M / +1,630.4%



“family ties” accounted for 81% of H2 chart streams. Use the breakout to introduce listeners to other tracks and measure catalog engagement.

Bars show H2 chart streams on a common scale. The artist screen required at least 1M H1 streams, 10M H2 streams and a 100M gain. The export ranks qualifying credits by percentage growth and keeps up to 20.

METHODS & LIMITATIONS

How the analysis was built

01 Data and scope

Historical Spotify Charts records for 2017–2021. Stream-based queries excluded rows with missing stream counts and excluded the aggregated Global chart. The 2021 market and momentum comparisons also excluded South Korea because its chart series began during that year.

02 Units of analysis

Artist rankings use the artist credit as written in the source. A joint credit is a separate group. Track rankings group by artist credit and title. The case-study track queries consolidate capitalization variants within each artist credit.

03 Metric definitions

Market over-index compares two shares computed on the same 2021 market set. Momentum compares January–June with July–December using both absolute gain (H2 minus H1) and percentage growth (gain divided by H1).

04 How to use the results

Chart streams cover charting activity only. Market coverage changed over time, and a zero in a half-year indicates no counted chart streams in the export. The thresholds are analyst-selected. Observed gains alone cannot identify which campaign or event caused them.

PROJECT WORKFLOW

I used PostgreSQL and DBeaver to query and aggregate chart records, exported the results to CSV, and built a Power BI report. This case study uses static charts regenerated from those exports.